```
    }
  }
}
```

❶ Section to configure the connection with a container registry

❷ Section to configure authentication to the publishing container registry. The values are passed as Gradle properties.

The details on how to authenticate with the container registry are externalized as Gradle properties both for flexibility (you can publish the image to different registries without changing the Gradle build) and for security (the token, in particular, should never be included in version control).

Remember this golden rule of credentials: you should never give your password away. Never! If you need to delegate some service to access a resource on your behalf, you should rely on an access token. The Spring Boot plugin lets you use a password to authenticate with the registry, but you should use a token instead. In section 6.1.3, you generated a personal access token in GitHub to let you push images to the GitHub Container Registry from your local environment. If you don't know its value anymore, feel free to generate a new one following the procedure I explained earlier in the chapter.

Finally, you can build and publish the image by running the `bootBuildImage` task. With the `--imageName` argument, you can define a fully qualified image name as container registries require. With the `--publishImage` argument, you can instruct the Spring Boot plugin to push the image to the container registry directly. Also, remember to pass values for the container registry via the Gradle properties:

```
$ ./gradlew bootBuildImage \
    --imageName ghcr.io/<your_github_username>/catalog-service \
    --publishImage \
    -PregistryUrl=ghcr.io \
```